

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



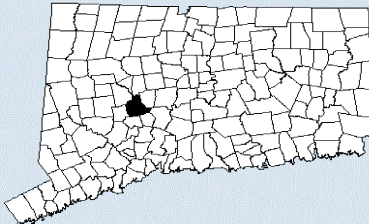
Waterbury School District

Dr. Verna Ruffin, Superintendent • 203-574-8004 • www.waterbury.k12.ct.us

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	58
Enrollment	18,450
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$15,274
Total Expenditures ¹	\$290,266,909

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	8,863	48.0	48.4
Male	9,587	52.0	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	285	1.5	5.2
Black or African American	3,960	21.5	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	10,818	58.6	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	669	3.6	4.0
White	2,609	14.1	49.9
English Learners	2,965	16.1	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	14,073	76.3	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	3,625	19.6	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	3,912	45.1	77	0.8
Male	4,619	50.4	148	1.5
Black or African American	2,033	52.1	73	1.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	5,278	50.5	112	1.0
White	790	32.6	25	0.9
English Learners	1,515	50.6	20	0.6
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	7,594	51.4	211	1.3
Students with Disabilities	1,982	56.0	96	2.3
District	8,531	47.8	225	1.2
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 3,466

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	1,138.6
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	71.7
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	203.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	349.5
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	26.8
School Level	80.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	25.0
Support Staff	3.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	57.4
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	94.4
School Nurses	30.4
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	663.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	2	0.1	0.1
Asian	26	1.6	1.3
Black or African American	77	4.7	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	146	9.0	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	8	0.5	0.1
White	1,367	84.0	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	8.4	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	202	72.1	238	84.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	433	70.4	446	82.3
White	155	80.7	166	81.8
English Learners	107	66.9	105	78.9
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	714	76.0	760	84.5
Students with Disabilities	178	73.3	210	80.5
District	833	72.9	895	82.5
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	124	35.7
Emotional Disturbance	66	26.4
Intellectual Disability	29	26.6
Learning Disability	1,024	67.9
Other Health Impairment	382	59.9
Other Disabilities	29	22.0
Speech/Language Impairment	326	80.9
District	1,980	58.4
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	358	2.0	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	250	1.4	1.1
Intellectual Disability	110	0.6	0.5
Learning Disability	1,510	8.4	5.8
Other Health Impairment	641	3.6	3.3
Other Disabilities	267	1.5	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	416	2.3	1.9
All Disabilities	3,552	19.8	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	99	2.8	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	136	3.8	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$189,001,142	\$9,945	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$9,551,526	\$511	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$23,515,120	\$1,258	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$7,406,980	\$396	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$15,312,194	\$819	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$4,962,425	\$265	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$16,797,996	\$898	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$13,255,782	\$926	\$1,159
Food services	.	.	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$10,463,745	\$560	\$151
Total	\$290,266,909	\$15,274	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$19,961,871	29.4	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$97,642	0.1	11.1
Other Salaries	\$12,951,201	19.1	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$16,158,873	23.8	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$3,815,633	5.6	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$8,378,813	12.3	22.5
Supplies	\$372,894	0.5	0.5
Property Services	.	.	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$6,108,983	9.0	7.2
Equipment	\$11,830	0.0	0.2
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$67,857,741	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		23.4	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	31.3
State	61.4
Federal	6.8
Tuition & Other	0.5

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	286	81.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	628	80.6
English Learners	163	78.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,133	81.7
Students with Disabilities	246	61.8
District	1,201	82.1
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	83.3	102	9.1
Male	78.0	83	7.5
Black or African American	81.7	33	5.9
Hispanic or Latino	78.7	62	5.4
White	84.1	73	18.5
English Learners	75.4	7	2.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	79.6	113	6.1
Students with Disabilities	63.3	*	*
District	80.6	185	8.3
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	61.4	73.6
Male	42.2	53.3
Black or African American	53.6	66.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	45.7	57.7
White	66.8	78.3
English Learners	28.0	59.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	53.8	65.4
Students with Disabilities	28.3	47.0
District	52.8	65.6
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	47.8%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	50.8%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	77.6%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	8.3%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		76.1%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		82.1%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		82.4%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		52.8%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		40.5%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	69.7%	82.4%	-12.7%	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

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Waterbury School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Waterbury Public Schools (WPS) implemented a new strategic operating plan, setting direction for the next five years. The plan included hiring of school counselors at all elementary schools and development of a school counseling curriculum. The district uses an evidenced-based SEL curriculum that supports students of all ages to better comprehend and feel their emotions, and demonstrate empathy to make responsible decisions, achieve their goals, and build relationships. WPS announced a Waterbury Promise Scholarship Program, funding postsecondary education to students meeting high performance criteria. WPS also launched ParentSquare, a communication platform, ensuring all parents have the opportunity to participate in their child's education. 98% of families are connected to ParentSquare.

WPS secured a firm to conduct an independent evaluation of special education programs. A new Director of Pupil Services was hired and is working with staff to develop a strategic plan to target areas in the evaluation report. Specialized programs will be expanded due to a growing need for autism, behavior, and transition services. We will be participating in the state's pilot electronic IEP system. The district's relationship with DCF will continue with a pilot program providing services to three elementary schools.

WPS has worked to provide supports to keep students connected and engaged during the pandemic. Each school expanded the Chronic Absenteeism Team and created Care Teams. This team identified students struggling socially, emotionally, or academically, giving attention to weekly "no show" trends. When a student was absent without communication for two or more days, schools launched student re-engagement services, including home visits. The team offered support to students and families, collectively problem solving, co-creating solutions, and monitoring results to ensure students were able to fully engage. An extensive resource list was developed including connections to medical and mental health needs, food pantries, shelters, and transportation.

The district also worked closely with community partners to develop services addressing obstacles faced during the pandemic. Two partners offered social emotional supports in schools. We collaborated with others to launch "Project Waterbury" where schools could use 211 as a means of engaging disconnected families. The district began the process of rebuilding a mental health framework to address the social emotional and behavioral needs of our students. We facilitated conversations with community mental health providers to discuss service provision that is school-based. Parent liaisons held virtual meetings with families and staff members to plan virtual academic activities. Activities included virtual programs with local and regional vendors for Science, Reading, and Math Nights. Some schools had virtual activities to support SEL with at home learning.

During the first 40 days of the school year, the Human Capital Talent Office provided 81.5 hours of professional learning. Sessions included virtual engagement and instructional strategies, restorative practices, the benefits of SEL in social and emotional wellness, and addressing trauma. The district also hosted two attendance awareness days for staff to discuss best practices in hybrid learning.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

District students and staff represent many racial, ethnic, and cultural backgrounds. Students from diverse backgrounds interact with each other at all schools. The district and schools host activities such as Hispanic Heritage, Black History, and Multi-Cultural celebrations. WPS has three inter-district magnet schools; one with a multicultural and science theme, and two with an arts theme. Each magnet school draws at least 30% of its students from neighboring suburbs.

The Seal of Biliteracy was awarded to 81 students in 10 different languages for the first time. It recognizes students' academic efforts, the benefits of being biliterate, and prepares them to be 21st-century global citizens. WPS is opening an International Dual Language School, where students will learn English and Spanish in a dual immersion model.

WPS has increased the focus on minority teacher recruitment, including attending ten HBCU virtual career fairs and using a variety of recruitment platforms to reach as many candidates as possible. We are working with CSDE and SERC participating in the Educator Diversity Coaching Series. Partnering with TEACH Connecticut, we implemented a unique three-part recruitment campaign. Through the Relay Graduate School of Education and the RESC Alliance MTR Grant, WPS covered \$2,000 in tuition for paraeducators of color. WPS has partnered with local community organizations to offer monthly conversations for all employees surrounding race in education to welcome and nurture racial, ethnic, and linguistic diversity. Affinity groups for African American and Hispanic educators have also taken shape in partnership with a community organization.

WPS participated in the yearlong SERC professional learning series: Courageous Conversations & Courageous Leadership: Moving the Racial Dialogue to Systemic Racial Equity Transformation. WPS created a District Equity Leadership Team (DELT), which developed an Equity Action Plan and Equity Policy with strategies to create a culturally responsive workforce. The district hosted its 2nd Annual Equity Conference where staff participated in full day professional learning regarding the role of implicit bias in disproportionate outcomes for students of color.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

To allocate resources, district officials carefully weigh school and student needs against available funding, including state and federal entitlement grants. Principals have an opportunity to present budget requests for schools through their Assistant Superintendents. The district recognizes that not every school has the same needs. The Chief Academic Officer and Content Supervisors present budget requests for curriculum development or program enhancement. Some funds are allocated with district wide impact, others are related to specific school needs and enrollment. High poverty schools or schools with special programs may need additional support, older buildings may require updates, and some schools may experience changes in student enrollment. Some schools, such as magnet schools, have access to additional funding through the State. All schools have access to additional support through competitive grants and educational partnerships. Through careful consideration of all aspects of the budget, the district is able to provide an equitable allocation of resources to all schools, and all students.